This recipe depends on the quality of its few ingredients, so always try to use homemade stock, organic eggs, and the best Parmesan cheese you can find.

stracciatella with pasta

SERVES 4–6 **PREP** 10 MINS **COOK** 20 MINS **FREEZE** NOT SUITABLE

1½ quarts (1½ liters) chicken stock
½ cup soup pasta
4 eggs
salt and freshly ground black pepper
½ tsp freshly grated nutmeg
2 tbsp grated Parmesan cheese
1 tbsp chopped parsley
1 tbsp olive oil

1 Place the stock in a large pot and bring to a boil. Add the pasta and cook according to packet directions, or until *al dente*.

2 Break the eggs into a small bowl, add the nutmeg, season to taste with salt and pepper, and whisk lightly with a fork to break up the egg. Add the Parmesan and parsley.

3 Add the olive oil to the simmering stock, reduce the heat to low, then stir the stock lightly to create a gentle "whirlpool." Gradually pour in the eggs and cook for 1 minute, without boiling, so they set into fine strands. Let stand for 1 minute before serving.